

GROUP 8:

FINAL PRESENTATION

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COMPANY ACCESS

Organization: Playa Bowls

Location: 53 Mine Street, New Brunswick

Background:

- Opened in September 2016
- Over 300 locations nationwide
- First to target a college demographic
- Store is 1,200 square feet
- Employs around 25 workers (mainly college students)

Primary point of contact: Lily Dipalma (employee)

Secondary points of contact: Ella Mullane (shift leader) and Sherri Filippone (area manager)



OUTPUT PROBLEM

Lack of Quality Inventory!



“the lack of inventory
leads to many resources
going to waste.” -
Employee

“they were running out
of product” - Customer

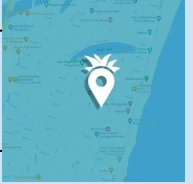
“bananas like this should never
make it into a customer’s
bowl.” - Customer

DATA COLLECTION METHODS (NOT FINDINGS)

Google Reviews

Interviews

Survey



**Shift Leader/Older
Employee**

Area Manager

**New Employee
(<1 yr)**

SUMMARY OF INTERVIEW DATA

- Interviewed 2 employees (Lily and Ella) and the area manager (Sherri)
- Inventory issues were stated as a major issue among all three interviews
- Lack of inventory checks
 - Resulted in shortages, inefficiencies, and waste
- Employees cited the absence of no on-site general manager
 - Had trouble establishing consistent communication with Sherri
- Sherri believed there were gaps in management causing issues
- New Brunswick location lags behind others in operations efficiency
 - Ingredients not ordered on a timely basis
 - Poor tracking of money and resources
 - Lack of essential equipment (e.g. no scale)
- Consensus was the lack of structure and proper oversight leads to inefficiencies and waste

IDENTIFICATION OF COURSE CONCEPT

- **Key Concepts: Role Clarity and Accountability**
- **Role Clarity Issue**
 - Employees often unsure of their expectations and responsibilities
 - Tasks were not assigned consistently (inventory, restocking)
- **Accountability Issue**
 - Nobody was directly responsible for completing tasks or oversight
 - Absence of performance standards
- **Impact**
 - Tasks left undone
 - Shortages and inefficiencies
- **Establishing clear roles and accountability leads to improved performance**
 - Strengthening both issues is essential for the future success of this location

METHOD FOR QUANTIFYING THE SEVERITY OF THE OUTPUT PROBLEM

- Survey
- Averaging Results to compare between locations

I feel a sense of community in this organization	On a scale of 1 - 10, I feel like my manager pr	My manager is resp
Strongly Agree	10	Strongly disagree
Strongly Agree	9	Agree
Somewhat agree	9	Agree
Agree	8	Somewhat agree
Agree	10	Agree
Agree	8	Agree
Somewhat agree	10	Strongly Agree
Agree	6	Agree
Agree	6	Neutral
Neutral	3	Somewhat agree
Agree	10	Agree
Agree	10	Strongly Agree
Strongly Agree	1	Disagree
Strongly Agree	5	Neutral
Strongly Agree	10	Strongly Agree
Somewhat disagree	7	Somewhat disagree
	9.142857143	1.285714286
1.777777778	6.444444444	0.888888889

Timestamp	What is your current role in the organization?	Do you work at the 53 Mine
3/18/2026 17:51:20	Employee	No
3/18/2026 17:37:28	Manager	No
3/18/2026 18:23:25	Manager	No
3/18/2026 17:39:43	Shift Leader	No
3/18/2026 17:45:16	Shift Leader	No
3/18/2026 17:45:31	Shift Leader	No
3/18/2026 18:53:47	Shift Leader	No
3/12/2026 17:40:16	Employee	Yes
3/18/2026 17:40:26	Employee	Yes
3/19/2026 18:22:39	Employee	Yes
3/18/2026 17:44:51	Manager	Yes
3/18/2026 18:29:07	New Employee (1 year or less)	Yes
3/12/2026 18:25:24	Shift Leader	Yes
3/18/2026 17:39:58	Shift Leader	Yes
3/18/2026 17:42:50	Shift Leader	Yes
3/18/2026 18:01:13	Shift Leader	Yes
	Strongly Agree = 3, Agree = 2 ... Disagree = -2, Strongly Disagree = -3	

QUANTIFYING AND CONTEXTUALIZING THE SEVERITY OF THE OUTPUT PROBLEM

- Found these things:
 - Compared with other locations (Marlboro), 53 Mine Street feels
 - Less prepared to do their work
 - Less sense of community
 - Less reliable on their manager
- Because of this, we see that
 - Because of communication issues internally and from not being able to establish direct communication with Sherri (the only person who can order supplies for each location), employees feel less prepared to take on the days work.

RECOMMENDATION

- To solve the issue of inventory, our group's recommendation would be to prioritize role clarity and to specifically assign employees to consistently check on the quantity and quality of the inventory.
- Our recommendation directly ties back to the concepts of:
 - Role clarity: employees must understand their roles and responsibilities.
 - Accountability: employees must keep themselves and their co-workers accountable to fulfill their responsibilities.
- Our group's logic behind our recommendation is that this location will not always have a general manager to depend on but the location can be efficient without one if employees are correctly trained to do specific tasks like keeping track of inventory.

RECOMMENDATION

- Companies that have implemented similar strategies to our recommendation include:
- **Starbucks** invests heavily in their training programs and emphasizes role clarification. The results of this include high quality service and knowledgeable workers
- **Ember Coffee Company** implements a “Responsibility Matrix” which is a tool that maps out each employee’s responsibilities. Results of this system include increased productivity and efficiency.
- **Toyota** implements standardized work, so every employee understands the expectations and responsibilities they carry at work and also are knowledgeable on the best way to fulfill their responsibilities.



Responsibility Matrix

Task	Primary Owner	Backup
Dial in espresso (7am)	Alex	Jamie
Deep clean espresso machine	Mia	Sam
Restock milk & alt milks	Jordan	Riley



SOURCES

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